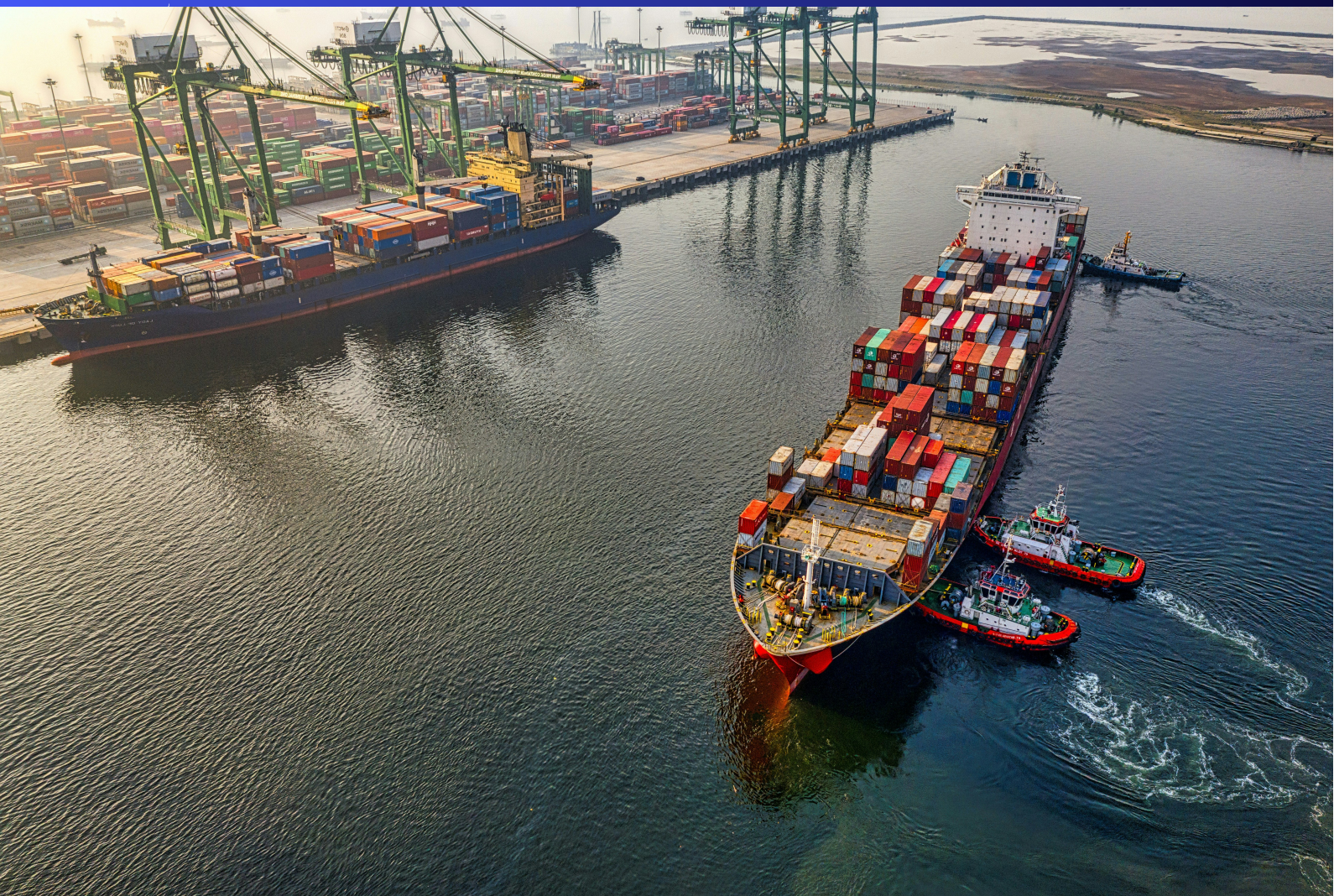




SHIPPING WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 16 MAY 2026 - 22 MAY 2026

POLESTAR-ADVISORY.COM

DATA STATUS: STATIC / IMPORT ONLY

LATEST RECORD: 22 MAY 2026

LAST UPDATED: 23 MAY 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Maritime reporting was centred on chokepoint risk, insurance and freight pressure and vessel attack. Iran produced the strongest identifiable signal, with lower volumes from South Korea and China. Severity peaked at moderate.

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 16 May - 22 May 2026	RECORDS IN WINDOW 11	HIGHEST SEVERITY Moderate
MAIN AFFECTED CHOKEPOINT Straits of Hormuz 5 records	VESSEL ATTACKS / SEIZURES 0	PIRACY / ARMED ROBBERY 0 Latest record in window: 22 May 2026
LATEST SIGNIFICANT INCIDENT 22 May 2026 Iran proposes permanent toll for Straits of Hormuz shipping		

CHOKEPOINT / ROUTE READ

The reporting window is led by Straits of Hormuz, which carries 5 qualifying records and a highest severity of low.

Across the window, 7 records pointed specifically at transit, diversion or advisory pressure — a tighter view of what shippers actually felt across the cycle.

Watch for new naval advisories on Straits of Hormuz, any war-risk premium adjustments and operator commentary on rerouting. Those are the early indicators of escalation; commercial freight rates lag them by days.

CHOKEPOINT	RECORDS	HIGHEST SEV	LATEST	OPERATIONAL READ
Straits of Hormuz	5	LOW	22 May 2026	Reporting was led by "Iran proposes permanent toll for Straits of Hormuz shipping", with 5 qualifying records in the reporting window.
Gulf of Oman	0	—	—	Quiet across the reporting window; no qualifying activity on file.
Arabian / Persian Gulf	0	—	—	Quiet across the reporting window; no qualifying activity on file.
Red Sea	0	—	—	Quiet across the reporting window; no qualifying activity on file.
Bab el-Mandeb	0	—	—	Quiet across the reporting window; no qualifying activity on file.
Malacca Strait	0	—	—	Quiet across the reporting window; no qualifying activity on file.

VESSEL THREAT AND PIRACY READ

Nothing hostile against vessels and no piracy or armed-robbery records reached the file across the reporting window (16 May - 22 May 2026). The underlying threat picture in the region has not been benign for long, so treat the quiet cycle as a reporting gap and keep crew-change, advisory and naval-patrol signals on the watchlist.

A return to hostile activity is usually announced first by naval forces, then by maritime risk bulletins, before it shows up in P&I or war-risk premium movement.

VESSEL ATTACKS (16 MAY - 22 MAY 2026)

No hostile vessel incidents on file in this window.

PIRACY AND ARMED ROBBERY (16 MAY - 22 MAY 2026)

No piracy or armed-robbery records in this window.

COMMERCIAL IMPACT ON SHIPPING

No port, freight, insurance or commercial-shipping disruption records reached the file in the weekly window. Pure market commentary — newbuild orders, vessel S&P, fleet finance, earnings, share-price moves — is intentionally excluded from this section, so a blank cycle here means the operational disruption signal was genuinely quiet rather than under-reported.

Watch for fresh port advisories, schedule slippage out of the major box and tanker hubs, and any insurance-premium adjustments tied to specific routes. Those are the next signals that operational commercial pressure is firming.

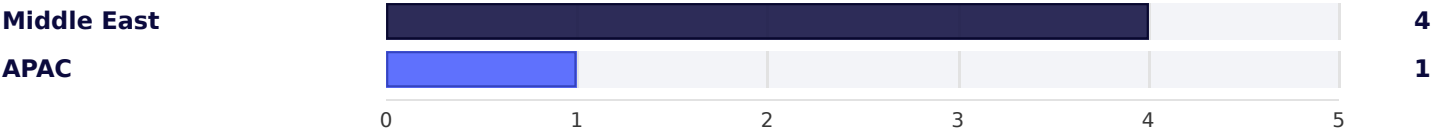
No port, freight, insurance or commercial-shipping disruption records in the weekly window.

REGIONAL AND COUNTRY VIEW

Across the weekly briefing window, Middle East carries the heavier share with 4 records against 1 for APAC. At country level the cycle is led by Iran (4) and South Korea (1).

A further 6 records could not be tied to a confirmed incident country and are excluded from the country chart to avoid distortion.

RECORDS BY REGION



RECORDS BY COUNTRY



WHAT MATTERS

Pressure here feeds straight into transit time, freight cost and war-risk premium exposure across the wider region. A small shift on any one chokepoint usually shows up in the freight and insurance read soon after.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Re-walk routing options around affected chokepoints, port-call sequencing, bunker planning and war-risk premium exposure. Confirm crew-change and advisory triggers with operators.

WATCH NEXT

- Next cycle hinges on a handful of triggers: fresh port closures or strikes, naval movement near Hormuz, Bab-el-Mandeb or the Malacca approaches, new maritime advisories, and visible moves in war-risk premiums or freight indices.

POLESTAR VIEW

Chokepoint exposure remains the dominant operational concern, supported by freight and insurance pressure and a thinner layer of commercial disruption. Iran carries the strongest identifiable signal, with lower volumes linked to China and South Korea.

RELATED INCIDENTS

DATE	ISSUE	TITLE	SEVERITY
22 May 2026	Chokepoint risk	Iran proposes permanent toll for Strait of Hormuz shipping	LOW
22 May 2026	Chokepoint risk	Strait of Hormuz closure risks greatest global energy supply shock in decades, Wood Mackenzie warns	MODERATE
21 May 2026	Chokepoint risk	Strait of Hormuz disruption helps drive 8% rise in Panama Canal transits	LOW
21 May 2026	Chokepoint risk	First coordinated VLCC transits through Hormuz raise cautious hopes of a thaw	LOW
20 May 2026	Chokepoint risk	FM Cho says probe into Hormuz Strait vessel attack in final stage	LOW
18 May 2026	Chokepoint risk	Iran to unveil Strait of Hormuz traffic plans, will collect tolls	LOW

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